

Psychology
Higher level
Paper 3 – resource booklet

Specimen paper

Instructions to candidates

- Do not open this booklet until instructed to do so.
- This booklet accompanies paper 3.

The sources in this examination have been collated to assess the claim that the use of technology in education may have a negative effect on the mental health of students.

Source 2

A sample of 50 students were either asked to complete an online task that would take up to six hours or they were asked not to use their computers for the whole day. There were 25 students in each group. At the end of the day, all students took a mental health test. The maximum possible score was 30, indicating a high level of mental health.

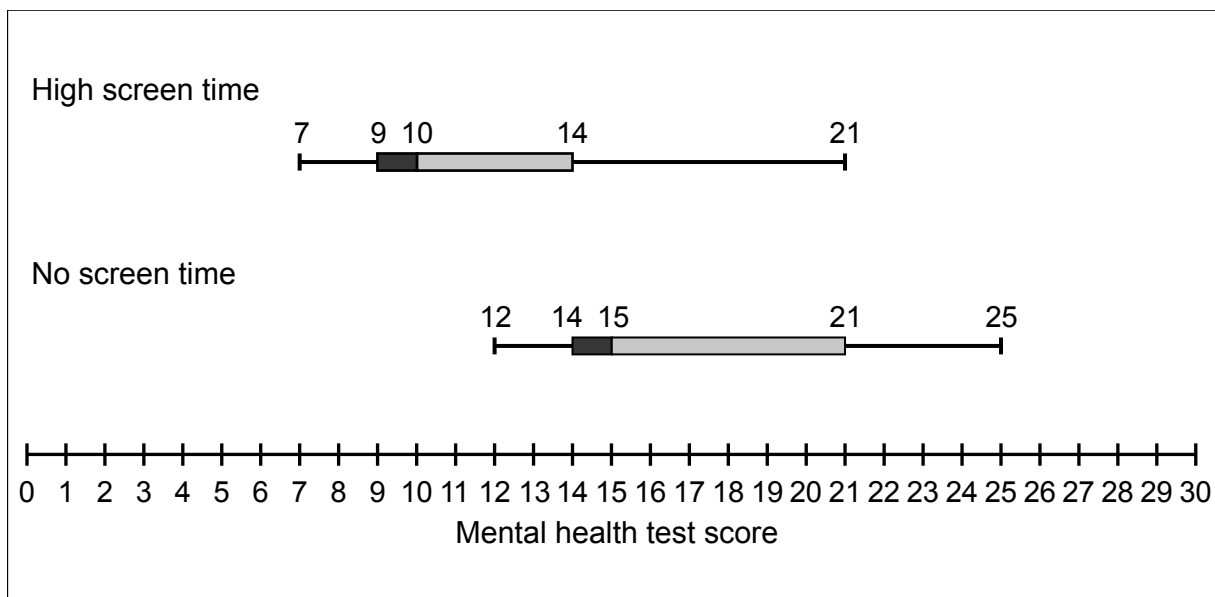
The table shows mental health test scores in relation to screen time.

Table 1: Mental health test scores in relation to screen time

	Scores on mental health test	
	High screen time	No screen time
Maximum	21	25
Median	10	15
Mean	11.6	17.64
Standard deviation	3.87	4.48
Minimum	7	12

The box and whisker plot in **Figure 1** is based on the data presented in **Table 1**.

Figure 1: Box and whisker plot based on the results of the mental health test



Source 3

A researcher carried out a series of focus groups with students from four different schools to discuss how online learning during school closures during the COVID-19 pandemic negatively affected their mental health. The researcher carried out inductive content analysis on the focus group transcripts and found the following themes:

- Isolation from friends led to feelings of missing out, anxiety, and loneliness.
- Extensive time with parents led to frequent arguing and feelings of being misunderstood.
- Online learning felt “unreal” and “detached” from “real education”.

Source 4

A study was conducted to analyse the correlation between mental health and hours spent doing homework on laptops. The participants took several mental health tests to measure levels of cognitive dulling (difficulty concentrating), depression, general anxiety, and obsessive–compulsive disorder (OCD). The results are shown in **Table 2**.

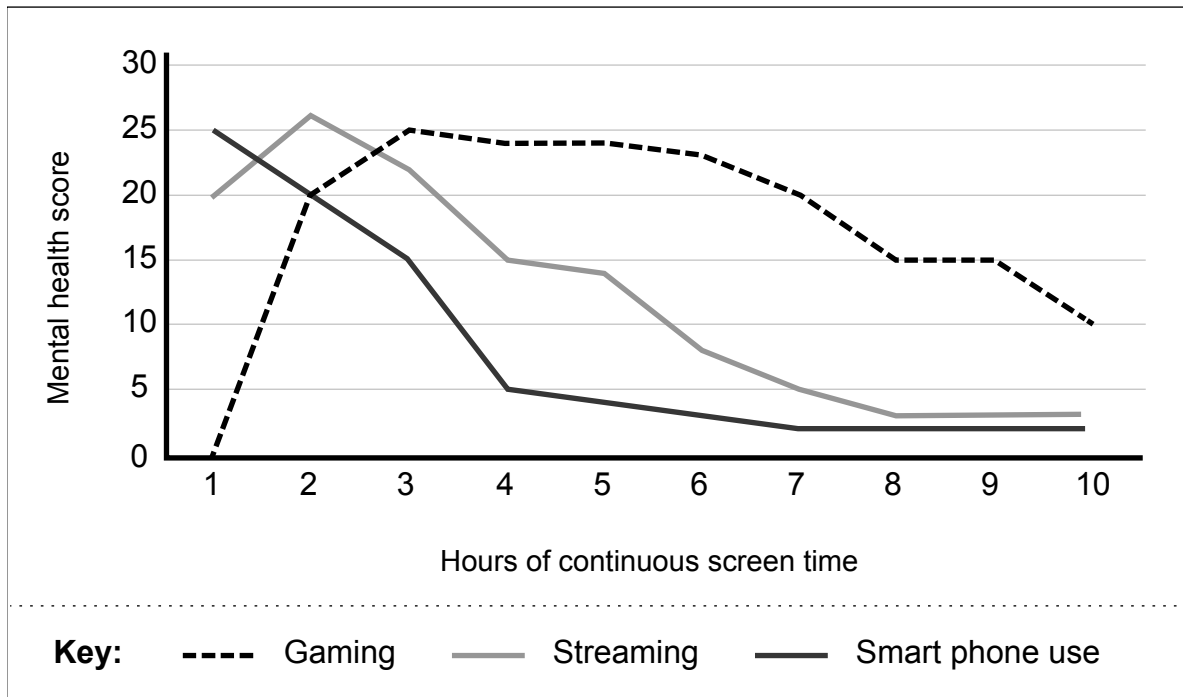
Table 2: The correlation coefficients of the aspects measured by the mental health tests and hours spent doing homework on laptops

Mental health test	Correlation coefficient
Cognitive dulling	0.25
Depression	0.76
General anxiety	0.80
OCD	0.12

Source 5

Figure 2 shows scores on a mental health test with regard to hours of continuous screen time in three areas: gaming, streaming, and smart phone use. Higher mental health test scores indicate better mental health.

Figure 2: Scores on a mental health test with regard to hours of continuous screen time



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